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AI Literacy and Ethics

A Community-Based Education Intervention to Improve AI Literacy and Ethical Use of AI in the Government Schools of Bihar, India

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Issue and Context

SDG-4 aims for quality education for all by 2030; however, we are still far from achieving the set targets. The COVID-19 pandemic further slowed progress toward this goal. With less than 5 years to achieve this goal, and the arrival of disruptive technologies such as AI in the field of education, the learning gap is only increasing. In low- and middle-income countries, learning poverty is estimated to have risen from 57 percent in 2019 to between 68 and 71 percent.[1] As of 2023, globally, 272 million children and youth are out of school, of which 78 million are of primary school age, 64 million of lower secondary school age, and 130 million of upper secondary school age.[2]

[1] https://datatopics.worldbank.org/sdgatlas/goal-4-quality-education?lang=en
[2] https://education-estimates.org/out-of-school/

This presents a strong demand for bridging the learning poverty gap and establishing structural peace in the world. The task becomes more ambitious with the increasing divide in capacity to leverage AI for learning. If not prioritized right now, the learning gap may increase. The problem is starkly evident in low- and lower-middle-income countries. On one end, we have nations leveraging this new technology and progressing in terms of literacy and access. On the other hand, many countries are facing a huge digital divide. India is one such lower-middle-income country.

As per Oxfam's India inequality report 2022, Ed-tech products (instruction aids in classrooms for teachers or at home for students) continue to remain inaccessible for many due to their high costs. The average cost of these products is estimated to be INR 20,000, while the average income of the poorest 20 percent households is INR 25,825. About 20% teachers reported that adequate training on delivering education digitally was not provided to them. Two out of every five teachers also claimed not to have access to the devices they needed to teach digitally.[3] Over 85% teachers in India have never used AI.[4]

In this context, I am interested in working on upskilling teachers to leverage AI in the classroom and educating students regarding the ethical use of AI. I envision piloting this project in the state of Bihar, which continues to have one of the lowest literacy rates in India. The project is rooted in the community by hiring AI-training facilitators from the local community to build social cohesion and is aimed at building structural peace by strengthening government schools and engaging communities.

Why AI Literacy? Why Now?

Why AI Literacy? AI is rapidly changing how we live and learn, and we need to prepare our communities for it. However, not everyone has the opportunity to understand or use AI responsibly. UNESCO's 2021 global recommendation on AI ethics urges that people everywhere be equipped to use AI responsibly. It is important to focus on AI in education "because living in digitalizing societies requires new educational practices, ethical reflection, critical thinking, responsible design practices, and new skills given the implications for the labor market, employability, and civic participation" (UNESCO, 2022). Hence, equipping teachers, students, and communities to leverage AI for learning is the need of the hour because it is essential for future-ready students and to ensure technology becomes a tool for upliftment rather than a source of inequality.

Why now? In today's world, artificial intelligence is no longer a distant, specialized domain; it increasingly touches everyday life and work. From smartphone voice assistants and social media algorithms to automated machines in agriculture, AI-based systems are becoming prevalent. For students in secondary schools today, by the time they join the workforce, AI fluency will be an essential skill, much like how basic computer literacy became essential in the past decades. AI literacy involves understanding what AI is, how it works at a conceptual level, and how to use AI tools effectively and ethically. There is a growing

[3] https://idronline.org/article/inequality/indias-digital-divide-from-bad-to-worse/
[4] https://educationforallinindia.com/ai-in-indian-school-education-challenges-curriculum-teacher-training/

consensus that exposing young learners to AI concepts at school will better prepare them for future careers and civic life. In India, the government and educational boards have acknowledged this need; for instance, the Central Board of Secondary Education introduced AI as an optional subject in Class IX as early as 2019, making India one of the early movers in K-12 AI curriculum. However, policy intent has yet to translate into on-ground capability in most government schools. The AI Literacy project steps in to fill this gap by developing age-appropriate AI learning modules and training teachers and youth to deliver them.

What is AI Literacy?

AI literacy can be defined as the set of knowledge, skills, and attitudes that enable individuals to understand and engage with artificial intelligence in an informed and responsible manner. It is an emerging concept that extends the idea of digital literacy into the realm of intelligent machines and algorithms. Stanford Teaching Commons has provided an overview of what AI literacy means. They have classified it into 4 broad literacies that together form the base of AI literacy:

- **Functional Literacy:** Knowledge of how AI works, how to access it, awareness of ongoing development of AI technology (e.g., AI as a composite voice, rather than specialized, culturally sensitive).
- **Ethical Literacy:** Practices for responsible and ethical use of AI (e.g., accuracy, bias, reliability).
- **Rhetorical Literacy:** Effective use of language to achieve a goal (e.g., agency, own voice as an author).
- **Pedagogical Literacy:** Integrate teaching and learning practice with AI to support student learning and development.

AI has emerged as a rather powerful technology, more powerful than previous tech developments, because of its power to mimic human responses. This calls for a human-centered approach to AI. In 2024, UNESCO released the AI Competency Framework, which focuses on four core values:

- **A human-centered mindset**: Encouraging students to understand and assert their agency in relation to AI.
- **Ethics of AI**: Teaching responsible use, ethics-by-design, and safe practices.
- **AI techniques and applications**: Providing foundational AI knowledge and skills.
- **AI system design**: Fostering problem-solving, creativity, and design thinking.

This framework encourages integrating AI-related topics into core subjects across the curriculum, emphasizing interdisciplinary learning in both STEM and the social studies (UNESCO, 2024). In the context of this project, AI literacy and ethics intervention aims to educate and upskill individuals so that they know what AI is and how to use it, and develop the mindset to use it responsibly.

Pilot Region: Bihar, India

Bihar is one of India's most educationally challenged states in India, which is why it has been chosen as the focus area for this intervention. Bihar is the third most populous state in India, with over 100 million people, predominantly rural and with a high proportion of youth. According to the latest Census (2011), Bihar's literacy was only 61.8% (male 71.2%, female 51.5%), compared to 72.98% nationally. The literacy rate in Bihar has improved since the last census (74.3%) but continues to be below the national average (80.9%). Further, ~89% population in Bihar is rural, with approximately 83% schools in rural areas. Only 18.5% schools have internet access, and a mere 23% schools have ICT labs.[5] In terms of technology familiarity and leveraging it for education, many youths can operate phones but struggle with "beyond basics" (e.g., reading instructions, financial calculations). Among youth who could bring a smartphone, the ability to execute simple digital tasks like setting an alarm or browsing for info ranged from ~70–87% depending on enrolment. This means they are familiar with technology and have access to it (ASER 2024, p.94).[6]

On the teachers' front, Bihar has a high pupil-teacher ratio (32:1). In fact, a recent report flags that Bihar has an issue of no teacher/one teacher/two teachers per school. 29 schools have no teachers, and 354 schools across the state have only one.[7]

Despite these challenges, government schools remain the backbone of Bihar's education system as well as the main avenue for disadvantaged children to learn. Over 80% of rural children in Bihar are enrolled in government schools, much higher than the national average of ~66% reliance on government schools (ASER, 2024). This reflects the limited presence of private schools in many rural areas, as well as the inability of poorer families to afford private education. Therefore, any educational intervention in Bihar must work through the government school system to reach the vast majority of children, especially those from low-income and marginalized backgrounds.

Bihar presents a context of high need as it has low learning levels, resource-constrained schools, and large inequities (gender, rural-urban, socio-economic) in education outcomes. At the same time, it presents an opportunity. The state government and civil society in Bihar have been striving to improve education, and the community recognizes education as a pathway out of poverty. However, in practice, most schools in Bihar are far from ready to teach such content without capacity building. This project's focus on AI literacy in Bihar is thus well justified. It targets a region where the needs are greatest. By piloting in Bihar's government schools, the project aims to create a model that, if successful, can be expanded in Bihar and adapted to similar low-resource settings across the country.

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[5] https://educationforallinindia.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/Universal-School-Education-in-Bihar-UDISEPLus-2023-24-data.pdf
[6] https://asercentre.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/12/ASER_2024_Final-Report_13_2_24.pdf
[7] https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/patna/acs-orders-temporary-deputations-at-schools-with-no-teachers/articleshow/123099684.cms

This peace lab project is a community-based initiative to introduce AI literacy and ethics in government schools in Bihar, India. By AI literacy, we mean giving students and teachers the ability to understand what AI is, how it works, and how to use it responsibly. We are creating an AI Literacy and Ethics curriculum for young learners that covers basic concepts (like examples of AI in daily life) and important issues such as privacy and bias. The learning will be fun and relatable, using stories, local examples, and hands-on activities to demystify AI. Ultimately, the goal is to build a foundation of tech knowledge and values so that when these kids encounter AI in their daily lives, they have the awareness and critical thinking to handle it responsibly.

Target Groups and Learning Outcomes

Target groups: Primarily, there are three target groups for this project: 1) Students (Grade 6-9), 2) Teachers, and 3) Community trainers. For community trainers and teachers this program will focus on providing training and pedagogical expertise to integrate ethical use of AI in education, in the classroom, and beyond. For middle-school students (Grades 6–9) targeted in this project, AI literacy will be introduced in a pedagogically suitable way. Rather than complex theories, it will focus on tangible examples and interactive learning.

Learning Outcomes for Students

Through this program, students will be able to:

1. Learn and use basic terminologies (e.g., AI, algorithm, machine learning, chatbot).
2. Identify AI applications in daily life (like face unlock on phones, voice-to-text translation, spam filters in email, personalized recommendations on streaming platforms).
3. Engage in meaningful classroom activities (without computers) to illustrate how AI works.

Classroom Activity | Grades 6-7

Simulate how a decision tree or neural network might function. Teacher and community trainer conduct a decision tree activity to identify festivals using yes/no responses and branching responses.

- Teachers provide a list of festivals and a list of categories for classification. For example, ‘Is it a national festival or local festival?’, ‘Which season- is this festival celebrated in spring/summer/autumn/winter?’.
- Students first prepare the “training data” i.e. classify the list of festivals based on the given categories.
- Students then build a decision tree by asking the yes and no questions and thus learn how machines make a decision.
- The activity can then continue in rotation with one student picking a festival from the data and other students identifying the festival.

4. Complete 2 mini-AI projects using simple tools. For example, they might train a mini AI model (such as using an educational tool to classify pictures of animals) to grasp the idea of training and inference.

Mini-AI Project 1: Train an AI model (Image Classification) | Grades 6-9

Learning: Training and Inference in AI
Tool: Teachable Machines by Google [Link]
This activity will be same for all grades. However, data set will vary. For Grade 6-7, image classification (local animals: to tell cow from goat). For Grade 8-9, image classification (urban Bihar from rural Bihar) or (posture classification using live camera and under the supervision of teacher and community trainer).

- Teacher and community trainer help students collect images data required for classification. They encourage students to click required images on their phones and not just rely on the online available data. Data should include images from different angles (zoomed in, zoomed out, sideways etc.)
- Using Teachable Machines by Google, teacher creates two classes (cow, goat; urban Bihar, rural Bihar)
- **Group activity:** Students upload images in their respective class (e.g., images of cow in "cow class")
- Students then click the 'train model'.
- **Reflection Activity** led by teacher and community trainer: Think and write, what might AI notice about images. For animals it could be size, color, horns etc. For rural and urban distinction, it could be buildings, homes, roads etc.
- **Individual activity:** Then, using 'Preview' or 'Use Model' mode, students take turn, show a new relevant image (e.g. image of a cow NOT in the data set, or a hand drawing of cow) and ask the AI to predict the answer.
- **Follow up activity** led by teacher and community trainer lead the follow up activity. Think and write, when was AI correct? When was it wrong? Was our data diverse enough to represent the broad groups?

5. Participate in discussions and case studies that cover the ethical use of AI.

Discussion Activity | Grade 8-9

Learning: Ethics and Bias
Scenario: A company is using AI in their hiring process. They use it to screen resumes, candidate's profile, and motivation letter. Think about fairness and bias in this scenario.

6. Learn how to verify information by gaining media and information literacy in the age of AI, such as understanding deepfakes, algorithmic news feeds, etc., so that they are not misled by AI-generated content.

Learning Outcomes for Teachers

Through this program, teachers will be able to:

1. Explain core AI concepts (e.g., algorithms, machine learning, everyday AI applications) in age-appropriate language to students in Grades 6–9.
2. Facilitate at least one AI literacy lesson per week using the provided modules, integrating interactive and discussion-based methods in their lectures.
3. Guide classroom discussions on AI ethics, helping students identify potential risks (bias, misinformation, privacy issues) and articulate responsible uses of AI.
4. Adapt AI literacy activities to local constraints (large classes, low tech access) by using no-tech/low-tech activities, group work, and bilingual resources.
5. Use basic digital tools more confidently (e.g., slides, videos, simple AI demos) to support their broader teaching practice beyond the AI module.

Learning Outcomes for Community Trainers

Through this program, teachers will be able to:

1. Demonstrate a working understanding of foundational AI concepts and examples.
2. Co-plan and co-teach AI literacy sessions with school teachers, following the curriculum and adapting facilitation style to different classroom contexts.
3. Design and mentor small student AI mini-projects that connect AI ideas to local community issues (e.g., agriculture, health, environment, misinformation).
4. Learn school-centered facilitation skills (questioning, feedback, inclusive participation) to engage diverse students.
5. Document session feedback and basic monitoring data (attendance, challenges, student responses) and communicate this to the project coordinator for ongoing improvement.

Key Deliverables

This project is designed to deliver the above outcomes through a comprehensive, community-grounded strategy. Community trainers will be locally hired. Instructions in modules will be bilingual to adapt them to the needs of the community. This project includes five key deliverables:

1. **AI Literacy Modules:** These will be a complete set of AI Literacy & Ethics modules tailored for Grades 6–9. They will be organized as a teacher/community trainer handbook and student activity guides. These modules and guides will be curated and rooted in credible online resources such as

Stanford Teaching Commons, UNESCO's AI ethics guidelines, etc. These will be created before the start of the academic year.

2. **Training:** Successful completion of the training programs – specifically, a 4-6 week bootcamp for community trainers and a 1-week teacher orientation workshop. By the end of these, the project will have at least 8 qualified youth trainers and approximately 10 school teachers oriented in the curriculum.
3. **Tech Support:** These include relevant subscriptions for teachers and community trainers. Teachers will be given the manager access to the learning app accounts.
4. **Impact Assessment:** Ethical impact assessment as well as M&E support both pre- and post.
5. **Feedback Channels:** Active grievance redressal channel for teachers, community trainers, school management team, and parents.

Each of these deliverables will be tracked against a timeline. Broadly, the year 1 timeline is divided into 4 stages:

- **Stage 1: Discovery** phase. In this phase, we identify 4-5 schools for the pilot. Pilot district: Madhubani, Bihar.
- **Stage 2: Planning and training** phase. In this phase, we develop and finalize instruction modules, define milestones, and complete bootcamp for community trainers and teachers.
- **Stage 3: Execution** phase. We train government teachers in the first week of school. Teachers and community trainers then co-teach AI literacy classes from the next week. Frequency: Once a week.
- **Stage 4: Review** phase. By the end of year one, students complete two AI mini projects. Data is reviewed, analyzed, and presented to the school officials as well as the government.

By having clear deliverables, the project aims to demonstrate concrete progress. These deliverables also lay the groundwork for scaling the project. For example, the curriculum and training materials can be reused or expanded to more schools in Year 2; the established classes in pilot schools become exemplars for other schools.

Stakeholder Analysis

The success of this project depends on the involvement and cooperation of multiple stakeholders, as this project involves government schools, the local community, teachers, and school buy-in. Each stakeholder has distinct roles and interests. Engaging these key stakeholders is crucial for the effective implementation and sustainability of this project. Below is a detailed stakeholder analysis for this project:

Stakeholder	Type	Influence on the project	Potential benefits/risks to stakeholder	Engagement Strategy	Engagement Frequency	Notes

School Education Department, Govt. of Bihar	Government	High – approvals, timetable directives, curricular alignment, scale-up	Benefit: NEP/NCF-aligned pilot, visibility, NEP execution partner Risk: reputational if poorly governed	Formal MoU align to NEP/NCF share program data Share videos from students, teachers, and facilitators for the official website share short dashboards & briefers	Quarterly + as needed	
District Education Office (DEO) & DIET	Government	High – school selection, monitoring, QA	Benefit: improved outcomes, model for other blocks Risk: admin burden	District steering committee Joint visits to schools	Monthly, termly learning reviews	Identify 4–6 pilot schools; designate focal officer
School Principals/Headmasters	Institution	High – timetable control, SMC convening, lab access	Benefit: better engagement & results. Risk: timetable disruption	Principal onboarding micro-SOPs for Principals contribute to school through volunteer work	Bi-weekly check-ins monthly huddles	Single point of contact for project execution
Subject Teachers (Grades 6-9)	Primary beneficiaries of the project	High – co-delivery, training, assessment	Benefit: Professional Development reduced prep pressure. Risk: perceived workload	Co-deliver lessons in class simple rubrics mapped to syllabus	Weekly coordination	If the school is facing teaching staff shortage, facilitators can also take classes individually
Community-based AI Facilitators (local youth trainers)	Workforce (community)	High – delivery, projects, peace routines (ethical use, respect data	Benefit: paid role, skills, social cohesion	20–40h bootcamp +	Weekly supervision	Require local marketing for the

		privacy, no misuse of AI, local language instruction		monthly coaching stipend (10k/month) progression to becoming mentor in the community	Monthly Professional Development Seminar	role to select facilitators
Students (Grades 6-9)	Primary beneficiaries of the project	High – project execution, learning improvement	Benefit: skill building, knowledge of AI and how to leverage it, ethical practices, fact-check, rumor-resilience for a healthy use of AI	inclusive topics, small fun exercises, showcase days	Weekly classes; termly showcases	Track participation by gender/caste, remedials
School Management Committees (SMCs) & Parents	Community governance	Medium – legitimacy, engagement	Benefit: voice, transparency, inclusion	Monthly 30-min "learning & peace huddles" upskilling community	Monthly	How the program is contributing to peace and knowledge in the community
Panchayati Raj Institutions (GP/Block)	Local govt (civic)	Medium – civic data,	Benefit: visible problem-solving, local government engagement Risk: politicization	invite to showcases, invite to community programs	Bi-monthly	grievance channel would need to be established
Content Partners Central Square Foundation's (AI Samarth)	Knowledge partner	Medium – curriculum spine, Teacher Learning Materials, Training of Facilitators	Benefit: validation, reach,	Use public-good modules	Termly content review	Need to customize it as per the community Local language translation: Hindi/Maithili

Google.org / Google for Education	Funder/knowledge	High (potential) – grants, content/tooling signals	Benefit: scalable public-good model Risk: association if governance weak	Submit concept aligned to AI-literacy/teacher enablement co-brand showcase	Use Gemini as a GenAI tool in trainings and classes Quarterly/at milestones	Align with AI-Samarth-style public-good approach
Tata Trusts / Tata STRIVE	Philanthropy	Medium – multi-year grants, skilling	Benefit: systemic pilot Risk: scale expectations	2–3 yr grant ask, Bihar scale plan Co-brand showcase	Bi-annual	Emphasize community trainers
NASSCOM Foundation / HCL Foundation / SBI Foundation	CSR platforms	Medium – devices, volunteers, local grants	Benefit: community impact at scale Risk: budgets constraints	Share program insights Co-brand showcase	Quarterly	Tie funding to simple KPIs (projects, attendance, trust, informed use of technology)

Theory Of Change

The Theory of Change for this project outlines how the training modules (inputs) will lead to outputs, intermediate outcomes, and long-term impacts. The theory of change also includes assumptions that have been made to make this project a success. This theory of change is the foundation of this project and presents a roadmap that connects the intervention to its ultimate goals of improved education (AI literacy and ethics) and peace in the community.

Inputs:	Outputs:	Intermediate Outcomes:	Final Outcomes:
AI Literacy modules a) for Trainers b) for Teachers (Grades 6–9) c) for Students (Grades 6–9)	AI Literacy in schools and communities: • Trainers are trained and are active in schools • Teachers complete training and co-teach AI	a) Trainers are better at facilitation, more confident, and have improved employability b) Teachers and Students know basic and ethical	AI literacy helps in • Improving learning outcomes (steady gains in class tests and exams)

• Short Trainer Bootcamp (20–30 hrs.), simple and NEP-aligned • Offline-first kit (printables) • Weekly AI period in school timetable	literacy awareness class with trainers • Students do small AI/civic mini-projects (e.g., rumor-check, safe-route map) • Monthly huddles to track progress	use of AI. They can do simple AI/Digital tasks for learning c) Teachers use AI for designing practice questions or checklists d) Students complete at least 2 mini-projects in an academic year	• Bridging the learning gap by providing equity in access to cutting edge technology in marginalized communities • Building a safer, kinder school climate (trust, no misinformation, fewer rumor issues, best practices) • Teachers use AI for planning and feedback on their own
Assumption:	***Assumption:***	***Assumption:***	***Assumption:***
• AI Literacy modules will help improve ethical and informed use of AI in govt. schools • AI literacy will lead to improved learning outcomes • Govt. and local bodies (schools, panchayat, principals etc.) are interested in this project. **Incentive:** Link to NEP • Local Youth is interested in the project. **Incentive:** Monthly stipend (INR 15K/month) • Teachers need training, are interested, and available. **Incentive:** Food and Snacks during the training sessions. Amazon gift cards (INR 1500/teacher) • Teachers and students will benefit from the training. **Incentive:** certification, free Gemini subscription • Every stakeholder has access to some type of electronic device. Students have a phone at home	• Local Youth is sufficiently trained. **Measure:** completion of training modules and weekly sessions with experts • Teachers are comfortable identifying and using AI tools. They participated in the training regularly. **Measure:** Circular from the Govt. to participate in the training • Students are comfortable identifying and using AI for education purposes. **Measure:** Participation in training and completing modules. • Principals and School administrative staff has given permission to trainers to co-teach once a week	• Training was helpful for trainers, teachers, and students • Trainers can get better jobs due to this work experience • Teachers and students continue to use AI even after the training	• Regular use continues throughout the year • Students' scores improve because they have access to AI. So, customized learning experience • Given that same AI tools are available for all (mostly), it leads to equity in access • Teachers and students consider AI tools useful • No harm caused

which they can bring to school once a week • Private organizations such as Google, Amazon etc. are interested in being project partners and funding. **Incentive:** Using Gemini for training, giving Amazon gift cards, and promoting these companies for their contribution.			

Potential Challenges and Measures

Implementing this project in a resource-constrained setting like Bihar presents several challenges and risks. Here are the key anticipated challenges and the measures put in place to address them:

Potential Challenges	Measures/ Incentives
Low-tech Infrastructure	• Offline first content (printed handouts, no-tech/low tech classroom activities) • Mobile-based access for students
Misuse or misinformation	• AI ethics modules • Teacher and community trainer guidance • Controlled environment. Group chat IDs managed by teachers
Trainer/ Teacher drop-out from the program	• Monthly stipend for trainers (INR 10k) • Gift cards for teachers • Monthly sessions with teachers and community trainers
Community resistance	• Local examples in activities • Bi-lingual instructions • Information session with parents and school officials • Parent consent for mobile access to students

Measurement and Evaluation Plan

To ensure that the project is meeting its objectives and to facilitate learning and accountability, this project includes a clear measurement and evaluation (M&E) plan. This includes defining what indicators will be tracked, how data will be collected, and how the project's success will be evaluated against its goals. Key components of the M&E plan are as follows:

- **Key indicators** such as:

  - learning outcomes for students (e.g., AI knowledge score through quizzes, scenario-based ethical reasoning ability, etc.)
  - learning outcomes for teachers (teacher confidence survey pre and post the intervention)
  - trainers (Key performance indicators-based evaluation)
  - class participation, completion, and engagement
  - school-level data on project completion, participation, and engagement
- The **data collection method** will be a mix of quantitative and qualitative methods. We will run
  - baseline and endline surveys and tests
  - classroom assessments through quizzes
  - lesson observations done by community trainers
  - Focused group discussions with students, teachers, parents, and school officials

Education and Peace

While education cannot solely lead to peace, it is the foundation on which peaceful societies are built. Research in peace and conflict studies has consistently found strong linkages between education and the stability of societies. A recent joint analysis by the Global Partnership for Education (GPE) and the Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP) (2024) provided compelling evidence: countries with higher school completion rates tend to be significantly more peaceful, whereas those with low educational attainment suffer more frequent and intense conflicts (GPE and IEP, 2024). This research provides evidence that nations that are ranked as highly peaceful have secondary school completion rates around 99%, whereas countries with low levels of peace average only about 52% secondary completion. Bihar's educational landscape, particularly in rural areas, and secondary education completion is very low. It is estimated that nearly 62% of students who start primary school in Bihar do not complete it to the end of Grade 5 (Parmar et al., 2025). When we look at these two studies together, we can say that despite being a state in one of the fastest-growing economies in the world[8], Bihar's education completion rate is a stark 10% below that of countries that have low levels of peace. This makes the AI literacy and ethics intervention project all the more necessary to promote peace, education, and development in the state of Bihar.

The AI literacy and ethics project not only aims to bridge the learning poverty gap but also to make schools a safer and kinder environment by including modules on identifying and curtailing misinformation and bias. A recent study provides empirical evidence that classroom-based education against misinformation can equip students to become more discerning consumers of information (Amar, Badrinath et al. 2025). This study was based on a field experiment in Bihar with 13,500 children in 543 different villages. Students who participated in this course became more discerning at telling true from false information, trusting scientific health practices, and judging source credibility after the completion of four 90-minute class- based course. Even after four months, the impact of the intervention was observed in

[8] https://www.worldbank.org/ext/en/country/india

students as well as the parents of students who participated in the course. In fact, students were able to transfer this practice to political misinformation as well, which was not a part of the course curriculum. Their research underscores that classroom-based intervention can have a larger impact in curtailing misinformation or bias, and thus promote a kinder, safer, and peaceful environment.

In the context of this project, the link between education and peace, and the strong impact of classroom-based intervention in curtailing misinformation, underpins the rationale for AI literacy as a peace-building intervention. By reducing the digital skill gap, this project aims to promote equality of opportunity in a technology-driven era. Including ethical awareness and critical thinking about AI in the modules, it also helps protect the community against threats like misinformation or abuse of technology that can lead to conflict. In the long run, empowering youth in Bihar with education (specifically, AI education) can contribute to greater social cohesion as these students will be better prepared to obtain decent work, engage constructively in civic life, and thus lead their community toward a more peaceful and prosperous future.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the AI Literacy and Ethics in Education project in Bihar is a timely and innovative intervention at the intersection of quality education, technology inclusion, and peace-building. This project aims to bring an AI literacy curriculum into government schools that have so far had little exposure to such content. The proposed curriculum also goes beyond tech skills. By integrating ethical discussions and collaborative projects, it aims to build critical thinking, empathy, and community engagement among students, teachers, and community trainers. This project promotes the idea that educating a child is not solely about that individual's future, but about strengthening the social fabric. By teaching young students in Bihar about technology and ethics, engaging teachers, community trainers, and parents, this project aims to build a future workforce that can participate in the global digital economy and can also uphold values of tolerance and critical inquiry. Each classroom activity, learning module, or ethical debate in class is designed to equip individuals with the tools to improve their lives and to cooperate with others.

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Acknowledgement: This final document was developed with the assistance of ChatGPT (GPT-5.1 Thinking, OpenAI), which I used to help structure the document and generate alternative phrasings. The project intervention theme, scope, core arguments, and overall conceptual structure are entirely my own, and I independently reviewed, revised, and verified all AI-assisted text and citations. This project does not copy-paste texts from ChatGPT responses. I take full responsibility for the final content and any remaining errors.